



PROGRESS REPORT

Regional collaboration: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01

Edition of 2026-09-01 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	State parties committed to expedite ratification and domestication under eight calls to action; no ratification count is published with them; the calls carry no enforcement mechanism, no ratification deadline and no named financing	Eight annexes to the protocol were approved in February 2025 and the intellectual-property annexes adopted in February 2026, and all of them still await national ratification and incorporation; the July 2026 calls to action to expedite ratification carry no enforcement mechanism, no deadline and no named financing, and no ratification count is published	ADVANCED, UNRATIFIED
AfCFTA Secretariat	Council bureau chaired by Egypt; the digital trade protocol adopted but no forum convened on it	Nigeria in the chair with digital trade among four stated priorities, a second digital trade forum held and a data-exchange system of the Secretariat's own launched	ADVANCED
Africa Internet Governance Forum	Baseline not held	The fifteenth annual forum is scheduled for the Labadi Beach Hotel, Accra, from 2 to 5 November 2026, running a main forum alongside youth, parliamentary and Day Zero tracks and the African School on Internet Governance; session times, venues and speakers were not published when the schedule was read	ADVANCED
African Telecommunications Union (ATU)	Under the mandate set at the sixth session in Algiers in 2022, chaired by Algeria	A secretary general elected for the next four-year term, a 25-state administrative council seated, the chairmanship passed to Nigeria and a ministerial declaration adopted; the union's plenipotentiary conference ratified the return of its headquarters to Kinshasa on 23 July 2026, after the host state paid more than US\$1.4m in arrears, with no date stated for the move	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
African Union Commission	Author of the Continental AI Strategy and the Digital Transformation Strategy, with no continental digital partnership agreement on record in the year before	Two cooperation instruments signed inside six months, with a US technology company and with the ITU, and a coordinated African position taken to the first global AI-governance dialogue	ADVANCED
AFRINIC governance and receivership	Under an appeal-court order of 15 October 2024 directing the Official Receiver to complete the board election within two months, in substitution for the six months ordered in September 2023; no reconstituted board at the window's start, six months past that deadline	The regional internet registry named a person to all eight board seats on 12 September 2025 while withholding every candidate vote tally its own election guidelines promised; the purported board and the undischarged receiver announced close collaboration from 13 October 2025 without publishing which office could sign, pay or veto, and no court order, delegation, bank mandate or responsibility matrix has been located behind it; the receiver appointed an audit firm on 13 October 2025 to audit three overdue financial years without an annual meeting, with no published appointment date, executed instrument, statutory route, remuneration decision or independence review; ordinary resolutions on US\$3.29m of disputed legal spending, put to the June 2026 annual meeting, were still unresolved on the public record 46 days later, and a January 2022 board resolution undertaking to bear all legal costs of a director in the Cloud Innovation litigation, carried seven votes to none, has never been closed out on the public record with a beneficiary, engagement, cap, invoice, payment or statutory classification; six regional members were named to a bylaws review committee without disclosing which constituents each represents; a member's challenge to the board's ratification of a policy draft remains open with an interim application declined and no reasoned merits decision; the appeal court set aside the registry's 2023 appeal for want of corporate authority without ruling on the receiver's permission or on statutory leave; a governance committee of three elected and two board-appointed voting members was constituted on 17 August 2026 on terms running to the ends of 2027, 2028 and 2029; the board, with the receiver's consent, named Mike Silber chief executive designate on 24 August 2026 for an assumption of office on 1 January 2027; and the Mauritius Police Force's Central CID confirmed on 27 August 2026 that two alleged forgery cases arising from the annulled June 2025 board election remain under investigation, the registry having never stated its reasons for the annulment	ADVANCED, AUTHORITY CHAIN UNRESOLVED
Algiers Declaration on African Telecommunications Sovereignty and Integrated Connectivity 2026-2030	Did not exist	Adopted as a continental position on integrated terrestrial, submarine and satellite infrastructure, local data centres, exchange points and cybersecurity; no work programme or text held	ADVANCED
Digital Parliaments Project Africa	Did not exist	Launch cohort of the parliaments of Ghana, Botswana and South Africa, the National Assemblies of the Gambia and Senegal, and the Pan-African Parliament, led by the POVOX-DPP Foundation with the House Democracy Partnership; no amount, duration, funder or work programme stated	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
Smart Africa Alliance	37 member states, working to the previous strategy	42 member states and a three-year strategy whose flagships are a data exchange, an innovation platform and digital identity; the secretariat issued two calls for expressions of interest on 13 August, one for content-delivery providers across broadband, data governance and cybersecurity and green-digital domains, and one for a consultancy to draft a gender-inclusion strategy for women's participation in ICT policymaking and governance, both closing on 31 August	ADVANCED
State parties to the AfCFTA	Baseline not held	49 of 54 signatories had deposited instruments of ratification as at July 2026, and Somalia is to become the 50th state party on depositing its instrument in September 2026, having agreed with the Secretariat a sequence running from ratification through domesticating the electronic tariff book and configuring preferential tariffs in its customs administration to a first shipment (2026-08)	ADVANCED
African Financial Stability Committee	BASELINE NOT HELD	Hosted by the Association of African Central Banks and running a Macroprudential Policy Development and Implementation Working Group and an African Financial Stability Report Working Group; the continental portal carrying its mandate, structure, member central banks, meeting calendar and working groups was built and launched by the Central Bank of Egypt rather than by the association's secretariat, executing a decision of the 47th Assembly of Governors of 2025-11-28	Baseline not held
African Financial Stability Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Inaugural 2024-2025 edition endorsed for publication by the Association of African Central Banks' 47th Assembly of Governors at Yaounde on 2025-11-28 and released in July 2026, covering 46 countries on data as at December 2024 with analysis through 2025. Its payments chapter, built from 26 central banks' published data, records that about 67 per cent of the continent's payment infrastructures are national systems run by central banks and 56 per cent of established systems handle retail, and finds the landscape fragmented, interoperability still limited and the operationalisation of regional and pan-African systems facing continuing challenges	Baseline not held
ATU Strategic Plan 2027-2031	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft Strategic Plan for 2027-2031 was circulated to member states for comment ahead of CPL-26; the draft is not published, and no adopted plan, budget or final acts of the conference are held	Baseline not held
Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation ministerial framework	Baseline not held	Eighth ministerial set for Seoul under the theme of artificial intelligence and digital infrastructure, convened by the continental development bank with new co-financing expected	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
CRASA (Communications Regulators Association of Southern Africa)	Not held	The association opened its 2026/27 financial year with the first meeting of its Finance, Risk and Audit Committee, a two-day hybrid session in Maseru on 20 and 21 August 2026 hosted by the Lesotho Communications Authority, at which the committee and the secretariat reviewed financial and audit matters and assessed institutional risk across the association's regional programmes. No budget, audit opinion, risk register or programme list reaches the base from it	ADVANCED
IDEA programme (Inclusive Digitalization in Eastern and Southern Africa)	US\$2.48bn approved in June 2024, phase 1 Angola, DR Congo and Malawi; no forum and no regional action plan	Phase I is Zambia, DR Congo, Malawi and Angola, with Eswatini, Tanzania and Madagascar preparing Phase II; a Strategic Action Plan and Digital Action Matrix for 2026-2027 agreed	ADVANCED
IDEA Project Steering Committee (COMESA)	Two meetings since the programme was approved in June 2024	Third meeting, reviewing implementation and risk with other regional communities, EACO, SAPOA, SATA and the World Bank	ADVANCED
SADC preparatory process for the ITU World Radiocommunication Conference 2027	No preparatory meeting on record	Closed at Luanda on 7 August 2026 with harmonised SADC Common Positions and Proposals on key WRC-27 agenda items; spectrum allocation for International Mobile Telecommunications was named the sensitive debate and the common position document is not published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Southern African Development Community (SADC)	Baseline not held	Chaired by South Africa from the 46th Ordinary Summit at Durban on 17 August 2026, taking over from Zimbabwe, with digital security named among the incoming chair's strategic priorities alongside energy, water, industrialisation and regional infrastructure, and accelerated implementation of SADC Vision 2050 and the Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan stated as the frame	ADVANCED
SADC Financial Inclusion Subcommittee	Strategy on Financial Inclusion and SME Access to Finance 2023-2028 under review; Financial Inclusion Information Portal launched (2024-02)	The February 2024 review is still the newest record held; no meeting, work plan or portal update since	NO CHANGE

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
Alliance of Sahel States (AES)	A common biometric passport launched in January 2025; harmonised document specifications validated but unpublished; no confederal card issued	Both confederal credentials issuing, a cross-border enrolment run on another member's soil, and a national data centre offered as mutualised AES infrastructure	ADVANCED
BCEAO (Banque Centrale des Etats de l'Afrique de l'Ouest)	Operating the SICA and STAR systems, with the instant-payment platform in test phase	Operating the union's instant-payment rail, participating in the ECOWAS payment project and preparing a pilot accession to the continental one	ADVANCED
Cotonou Declaration on digital transformation in West and Central Africa	Did not exist	Adopted by West and Central African states, committing to a single digital market by 2030; no implementation report, work plan or secretariat held in the nine months since	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS	Vision 2050 in force; the Supplementary Act of February 2010 the newest regional digital instrument the base held	Adopted a revised data-protection Act, welcomed Council instruments on open data, electronic communications, digital governance and roaming, and approved a regional cybersecurity body, in one paragraph	ADVANCED
ECOWAS project-preparation pipeline for digital connectivity	Did not exist	Digital connectivity placed alongside transport, energy and water in the pipeline for development finance and private investment; no project list, envelope or first report held	ADVANCED
ECOWAS regional postal-sector regulatory framework	The 2016 postal-sector Directive in force, with no revision on record	Officials from ten member states, meeting the Commission's digital economy and post directorate with the regional infrastructure preparation unit, the Pan-African Postal Union and the West African postal operators' body at Lome on 12-13 August 2026, validated the orientations of a revised Directive and the outline of a Regional Postal Master Plan 2027-2030, naming digital transformation, e-commerce, universal-service modernisation, consumer protection and financial inclusion as priority areas; consultations with member states on the revised Directive continue and neither text is published	ADVANCED
WATRA (West Africa Telecommunications Regulators Assembly)	Working groups established about two years earlier, with no technical output on record	Five technical reports finalised, a 23rd general assembly held at Lome, and a regional position stated on submarine-cable resilience	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.